

I have 2 supervisors that I report to. My immediate supervisor is the program director for TEC. She oversees the daily operations at the Tumaini schools so she is the first point of contact for any immediate communication. My second supervisor is part of the board of directors for TEC. We have regular check-in meetings as he is the head of the stem project. I don't report to the school head or the school admin but we sometimes work closely together for school projects.

Have you had an initial check-in with your supervisor to set up a work plan and to set goals for your work during your fellowship year?

Yes

Was this meeting helpful in understanding your role and setting goals for your fellowship year?

Yes it was

Please explain why you have not met with your supervisor and if you have plans to do so going forward.

Please briefly indicate 3-5 professional goals you have for the rest of your fellowship year. Your professional goals should align with your work plan.

- Establish a career guidance system for O-level up to A-level students
- Cultivate a fun, safe, and positive learning environment for my students
- Collaborate more closely with other teachers

How often do you check in with your supervisor?

Weekly

Have you had an opportunity to travel for work so far?

No

Describe this travel opportunity. Include location(s) and a brief description of the purpose of the trip(s).

I feel adequately prepared for my position's professional responsibilities.

Agree

Please briefly explain your response.

I have taught in a similar position before when I worked for USAP community school and was a stem tutor in college, so this has not been as hard as I imagined.

How did you travel to your host country and site? Please be specific

I purchased my ticket directly from the Kenyan Airways website. I flew from R.G Mugabe airport in Harare to Nairobi, and from Nairobi to Kilimanjaro Airport in Tanzania. My ticket was a one-way ticket and it cost \$650.

What kind of visa/ permit do you have or applied for?

Business Visa that lasts 3 months– in the process of applying for a residence permit

How did you obtain (or are obtaining) your visa or permit?

I paid for a business visa at the airport when I arrived.

Did you apply for and receive your visa / permit before heading to your host country or after arriving?

I got it after arriving at the airport

What costs were associated with obtaining your visa or permit?

\$200 for a business visa

Did you pay the visa / permit costs or were they covered by your organization?

I paid initially but I was later reimbursed by my host organization

Are you still having challenges obtaining your visa/ permit?

No

If yes, please explain further**g) Do you have any suggestions to help future Fellows navigate the visa / permit application process?**

Research to see if they will allow you to even fly to your host country without a visa. Research the costs of different visas and the periods they are active.

What vaccinations were you required to obtain prior to your departure? How much did your vaccinations cost? Did you get a yellow fever vaccination?

I was required to have the yellow fever shot. But I also added a typhoid shot. In total (I got them in Zimbabwe), I paid about \$100.

How was your arrival and first week in your host country? Any improvements that could streamline the assimilation process for future Fellows?

My arrival in the host country was great. I do not really think they can do better than they did for me. They gave me enough time to rest and tour the place before I started actively working. I was informed well on procedures and points of contact before I started working.

Is housing provided by and/or paid for by your organization? Please explain.

Yes, I live on school property.

Do you live in a location that is more urban or rural?

Somewhat Rural

Please describe your living environment

I would describe Makuyuni as rural but not remote. Which means you will have access to the nearby cities and services.

How do you typically travel between your home and your work? How much does your daily transportation cost and how long is your commute?

I live on campus so it is a 3-5 minute walk to the lab.

If you live in a more rural area, what are the closest urban areas you can travel to for shopping, airport, larger medical centers, etc.?

The nearest city is about 90 minutes, Arusha town, and that is where we go for grocery shopping. We usually go every two weeks. It is where we also get our school electronics fixed so sometimes to minimize costs, and save time, we try to combine work trips with grocery shopping trips. We buy fresh produce from the local market which is open every Saturday.

How is the weather in your host country? What season are you presently in?

We are currently in the summer season. It is very hot, but as we are entering the rainy part of the season hopefully the heat gets better.

What is the appropriate clothing for work and outside of work at your fellowship post and in your community in general?

Formal dresses and skirts that are below the knees. Anything at the knees, but definitely not above the knees. Dresses and shirts have to have sleeves or you put something on top. We are allowed to wear formal pants on Thursday and Friday. Closed-toed shoes. For men, just normal formal wear line formal pants, a shirt and some closed shoes, don't have to be formal shoes. For women, all clothing has to be a little loose and not tight.

How have you been spending your free time?

I often go to town for lunch or dinner. There are also places you can go eat and watch sports. Other teachers sometimes offer to be guides. Traveling to the next towns on buses is also an option. I am a big football fan so I often spend my weekends either watching football or playing chess online, or just hanging around with my colleagues.

I've been able to successfully navigate my personal/social life both back at home and at my fellowship post.

Agree

Please briefly explain your response below.

It is easier to make plans with the local people here and because I see them on a daily basis, it makes it easier to keep in touch. I have scheduled calls with friends once in a while. And I talk to my family and friends daily on WhatsApp.

Would you say you live and work in a safe area?

The area is relatively safe but because of wildlife, it is not advisable to walk by yourself at night

What precautions do you take to ensure your safety?

I do not go out by myself at night, or during the day if I can avoid it. I also try to avoid paths I am not familiar with.

What has been your experience with crime so far? (Please note that any security or safety concerns or incidents should be reported directly to PiAf staff per PiAf safety and security protocol.)

No, I have not

Describe the incidence of crime and the general security situation within your city/town. Could you recommend specific areas future Fellows might consider for safe housing? What about areas that should be avoided?

I have not explored enough of the area to know the dangerous area but fellows for this post do not need to be too concerned since housing is within the school campus.

Please refer back to the goals you set for yourself before orientation. Are you working towards these goals? Have you met any of them? Changed any of them? Please explain.

I have been happy with the progress I have made in improving my teaching skills and networking. I am still working on getting more comfortable exploring the local town and meeting people by myself.

Do you have any frustrations with your living arrangements, your work or your life outside of work?

Not at the moment

Has there been anything that you have needed but have not been able to locate or acquire?

Not really

How have you dealt with "culture shock"?

I would not say I have been culturally shocked but just a few interesting things have happened that have got me thinking, but just as learning moments

What about your experience thus far has been the most...surprising?

The intersection between my native language and Swahili

What about your experience thus far has been the most...challenging?

Having to explain to people all the time that I look Tanzanian because I am African and I can't speak Swahili

What are the top 3 things you miss the most from your home country or the U.S.?

- Going to watch sports on weekends
- Easy access to supermarkets and grocery stores
- Fast Food

What are the top 3 things about life in your host country that beat out life in your home country or the U.S.?

- The peace that comes with living in the middle of nowhere
- Everything is cheaper than at home or in the US
- Access to Nyama choma any day

How is your stipend being paid?

I get paid my stipend monthly and in US dollars. They are deposited in a US account.

How are you receiving your stipend funds?

Wire

Did you raise funds to cover part of your fellowship expenses?

I did not raise money, but I did get a waiver from PiAf. I have not taken on any additional work but I have been considering doing so, with the permission of PiAf, because my expenses have increased due to starting grad school applications

Please list any additional one-time or infrequent expenses not included in your monthly budget below.

Monthly Budget

Rent	Utilities	Furnishings	Phone	Home Security	Internet
\$0.00	\$10.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$30.00
Transportation	Fitness	Entertainment	Groceries	House Cleaning	Eating Out
\$20.00	\$0.00	\$50.00	\$50.00	\$0.00	\$40.00
Medications	Additional Health Insurance	Travel	Laundry	Other	Total Monthly Budget (Minus Entertainment & Travel)
\$0.00	\$0.00	\$0.00	\$20.00	\$300.00	460.00
Specify "Other"					
Credit card and bills payment back at home					

Final Thoughts

Please briefly explain your response about Orientation.

The discussions I had with previous fellows during the orientation were very helpful and prepared me for a few things that I encountered once I started working. It was mostly the culture differences and the expectations of the environment. The health talk and advice was also helpful in letting me know what immunizations I needed to get before leaving for my post.

Is there anything in particular that PiAf could cover at orientation that would have better prepared you for your fellowship post? Please specify.

I think the orientation was pretty exhaustive and covered most of the things needed. Some of the things I have encountered could not have been taught during orientation but I had to think through the situation in the moment.

Are you receiving sufficient support, materials and information from the Princeton in Africa office? What could we improve?

I think the information and support from PiAf has been sufficient so far.

As we plan the upcoming PiAf Retreat, we hope to incorporate some Fellow suggestions into our programming. What are some topics or sessions you would like to see at the Retreat? (We appreciate your feedback however, we may not be able to accommodate all suggestions or requests this year.)

I think it would be great to talk about helping the people in the communities without judging or correcting their way of life. Even if it looks and feels wrong, it is sometimes considered very disrespectful.
We could also discuss the issue of making work easier for your colleagues within the work place